

DESTINY 2: LEVIATHAN

The Complete Raid Compendium

A room-by-room, encounter-by-encounter reference to the original Leviathan raid and its Underbelly.

1. Raid Overview

Leviathan was Destiny 2's original raid, released in 2017. It takes place aboard Emperor Calus's immense world-eating Cabal ship. The raid is built around a central hub, three rotating encounters, a hidden maintenance network called the Underbelly, and the final confrontation with Calus.

The original Leviathan raid was later vaulted from the live game with the Beyond Light content vaulting changes. This document describes the original raid as it functioned in Destiny 2, rather than the later Derelict Leviathan destination.

Basic Structure

- Embarkment — arrival area and approach to the Castellum.
- Castellum — the central hub and standard-gathering encounter.
- Royal Pools — the Bathing Pools encounter.
- Pleasure Gardens — the Royal Beasts encounter.
- Gauntlet — the runner and charge encounter.
- Castellum — reused as the hub between major encounters.
- Calus — the final encounter in the Throne Room.
- Underbelly — the hidden maintenance network connecting areas and containing secret chests and Watchers.

Four Raid Symbols

Symbol	Associated encounter
Sun	Royal Pools
Beast / Dog	Pleasure Gardens
Axes	Gauntlet
Chalice	Emperor Calus

2. Embarkment

The raid begins with the fireteam aboard the Leviathan. The Embarkment is primarily an introductory traversal area rather than a conventional combat encounter.

- Move forward through the ship's exterior structures and Cabal forces.
- Follow the main approach toward the ornate palace entrance.
- The route eventually leads into the Castellum, which serves as the raid's central hub.
- The ship's architecture deliberately contrasts luxurious imperial spaces with industrial maintenance corridors.

3. Castellum — The Central Hub

The Castellum is the core navigation and encounter space. It contains four major doorways, each represented by one of the raid's symbols. The active encounter is indicated by the symbol associated with that room.

Standard Mechanics

- The objective is to collect three Standards and return them to the matching plate.
- A Standard Bearer appears near the relevant route and must be killed to obtain the Standard.
- The carrier brings the Standard back while the rest of the team protects the route.
- When a Standard is placed, enemies spawn to attack the plate.
- Standard Liberators attempt to steal the deposited Standards and must be stopped.
- Councilors create protective Psionic bubbles. They are most safely killed by entering the bubble and meleeing them.
- After three Standards have been successfully defended and deposited, the encounter completes and the associated door opens.

Navigation Principle

The Castellum is intentionally reusable. Rather than memorizing one linear raid route, learn the room's four symbolic doors and the paths that connect the hub to each encounter. After each major encounter, the fireteam returns to the Castellum before proceeding.

4. Royal Pools — Bathing Pools

The Royal Pools encounter is centered on five activation plates: one central plate and four outer plates. The outer plates are connected to the center by long walkways.

Core Mechanics

- Standing on an activation plate causes its chain mechanism to move.
- Players receive Psionic Protection while interacting with the plates, preventing the environmental damage that would otherwise become lethal.
- The team rotates between plates so that the chain mechanisms can continue progressing.
- Ceremonial Bathers periodically appear and pressure players on the plates. They are high-priority targets.
- The chains eventually reach their required state, enabling the damage phase.
- The fireteam then attacks the nine Censors in the center of the arena.
- During damage, Force of Will increases the team's damage output.
- When the damage window ends, the encounter resets to the plate/chain cycle.

Practical Team Flow

- Assign players to the four outer plates and center plate.
- Keep an eye on the status of the plate and chain you are responsible for.
- Rotate intelligently rather than abandoning an active plate unnecessarily.
- Kill Bathers quickly because a Bather can make a plate unsafe for its assigned player.

- When the Censers become available, group up and maximize damage during Force of Will.
- Repeat until all required Censers are destroyed.

5. Pleasure Gardens — Royal Beasts

Pleasure Gardens is the stealth-and-damage encounter. Six Royal Beasts patrol a large garden. The objective is to build a damage buff on the fireteam while avoiding detection.

Roles

- Two players use the Prism Weapons from elevated positions.
- Four players carry Royal Pollen and move through the garden.
- The Prism users provide aerial oversight and activate flowers when the ground team reaches them.

Empowering Spores

- The Pollen carriers approach designated flowers.
- A Prism user uses the Prism weapon's solar beam to activate the flower.
- Players near the activated flower receive Empowering Spores.
- The team repeats the process to build a higher stack of the damage buff.
- The larger the stack, the more damage the team can deal to the Royal Beasts.

Detection and Wipe Threat

- The Royal Beasts follow patrol routes through the garden.
- Avoid the beasts' detection zones while moving between flowers.
- If the team is detected, the safe-room route becomes critical.
- The team can retreat to the safe room before the Psionic Howl becomes fatal.
- The goal is to complete the buff-building route without being detected.

Damage Phase

- Once the team has built a sufficiently strong Empowering Spores stack, the group commits to damaging the beasts.
- Focus fire one beast at a time whenever possible.
- If the damage attempt ends without killing all beasts, repeat the flower route.
- The encounter ends once the required Royal Beasts have been defeated.

6. Gauntlet

The Gauntlet combines two runner lanes with four stationary shooter positions. The encounter uses colored symbols and a timing-based orb mechanic.

Initial Phase

- Two players are runners.
- Four players occupy the central/shooter positions.

- Psionic Charges appear and runners take them to the active sections of the Gauntlet.
- The runner reaches an encounter wall and must identify the row requested by the symbols.
- A red row is called: top, middle, or bottom.
- Shooters activate the two corresponding targets in the other rows so the runner can pass safely.
- The runner passes through the resulting orb and continues.
- Councilors appear and must be killed so that the route remains open.

Charge Deposit

- After completing the required run, the runner deposits the charge at the central receptacle.
- Successful deposits advance the encounter.
- The team repeats the run sequence until enough charges have been deposited.

Final Run

The encounter culminates in a group run in which all six players participate. Players must coordinate movement, orb collection, and the final deposit sequence. Failure to maintain the timing or complete the required deposits causes the encounter to fail.

7. Emperor Calus — Final Encounter

The final encounter takes place in the opulent Throne Room. Calus initially appears seated at the far end of the room. The fight alternates between the physical throne room and a Psionic projection space.

Opening Phase

- The fireteam enters the Throne Room and damages Calus's initial defenses.
- Calus performs a clap-like attack that sends players into the next phase.
- Three players are sent into the Mind's Eye / projection realm while three remain in the Throne Room.
- The projection realm displays symbols corresponding to the symbols seen by the players outside.

Mind's Eye Symbol Callouts

- The projection players identify the symbols appearing on their horizon.
- The outside players use those calls to identify the correct Psionic enemy.
- The correct Councilor is killed, clearing the required route.
- Communication must be concise: each symbol call corresponds to a specific location in the sequence.

Psionic Skull Phase

- After the symbol sequence, players encounter Psionic Skulls.
- Destroying skulls increases the Force of Will buff.
- More skulls destroyed generally means a stronger subsequent damage phase.

Return and Damage

- The players in the projection realm return to the Throne Room.

- Calus becomes vulnerable.
- The team uses the available platforms to damage him while managing the encounter's hazards.
- When the damage window ends, the cycle repeats.
- The final phase requires finishing Calus before the encounter's remaining opportunities are exhausted.

8. The Underbelly — The Leviathan's Hidden Maintenance Network

The Underbelly is the ship's concealed maintenance maze. It is not a normal raid encounter. It contains corridors, fans, doors, surveillance Watchers, secret-chest routes, and shortcuts between major areas.

Entering the Underbelly

A well-known entrance is controlled by a room containing six levers. The levers are used to open the concealed passage into the maintenance network. Multiple guides historically documented specific lever sequences; because this document is intended as a reference rather than a live-game puzzle solver, the important structural point is that the six-lever room is the gateway to the Underbelly.

Watchers

- Watchers are security drones positioned around parts of the Underbelly.
- They can trigger security responses if the fireteam is detected.
- Players commonly use stealth, line-of-sight breaks, or coordinated takedowns to pass security sections.
- The Underbelly therefore behaves more like a maze/puzzle-navigation layer than a conventional combat arena.

Major Underbelly Sectors

Sector	General role
Engine	Large industrial machinery and maintenance space.
Transfer	Connecting maintenance corridors and transfer routes.
Armory	Weapon-storage themed area and associated chest route.
Aqueduct	Water/utility-themed maintenance section.
Ventilator	Fan and ventilation machinery.
Pipeline	Long utility and pipe corridors.
Drain	Lower maintenance/drainage section.
Conduit	Electrical/utility infrastructure.
Irrigation	Water distribution and maintenance network.

Underbelly Navigation Philosophy

- The Underbelly is easiest to understand as a network rather than a single corridor.
- Large doors, fans, pipes, vertical shafts, and security rooms are the visual landmarks.
- The network contains routes toward multiple encounter areas, allowing players to bypass portions of the public-facing ship.
- Secret chests require specific keys obtained through raid activities.

- The Underbelly was also important for exploration, shortcuts, and the Leviathan's hidden collectible/chest structure.

9. Secret Chests and Keys

Leviathan included hidden chests distributed through the Underbelly. Keys could be earned through activities in the raid and were then used to open matching chest locations.

- Chest keys were tied to specific raid activity completions.
- Players used the Underbelly's maintenance corridors to reach the corresponding chest rooms.
- The chest system rewarded exploration and encouraged teams to learn the ship beyond the encounter arenas.
- Because the original raid is vaulted, these mechanics are primarily of historical interest today.

10. Prestige / Challenge Variations

The Prestige version of Leviathan introduced additional difficulty and changed mechanics in several encounters.

- Royal Pools: Oiled Bathers and the Burden of Worthiness mechanic altered how players handled plate duty.
- Pleasure Gardens: the number and behavior of Royal Beasts changed, increasing the difficulty of the stealth/damage cycle.
- Gauntlet: runner and orb mechanics were modified, with additional restrictions and altered final-run conditions.
- Calus: Councilor behavior and the projection/Throne Room interaction were changed.
- Prestige also used the relevant higher-level modifiers and encounter-specific restrictions of its era.

11. Weekly Challenge

Leviathan also had rotating challenge objectives associated with raid encounters. These challenges imposed an additional condition on a specific encounter and rewarded extra loot when completed.

The exact challenge rotation was tied to the game's weekly raid cycle and therefore should be treated as historical content rather than a currently active schedule.

12. Loot and Rewards

The original Leviathan raid rewarded encounter-specific weapons and armor, along with raid-exclusive cosmetic and progression rewards.

- Raid weapons had distinctive Leviathan-themed designs and perks.
- Armor was themed around Calus and the Leviathan.
- Encounter and chest rewards encouraged repeated clears.
- Prestige offered additional versions and cosmetic rewards associated with the harder difficulty.

13. Calus, the Leviathan, and the Raid's Presentation

The Leviathan raid was deliberately theatrical. Calus's ship is simultaneously a palace, a machine, a maze, and a test. The encounter spaces repeatedly contrast imperial luxury with industrial infrastructure.

- The Castellum acts as a ceremonial gateway and central control space.
- Royal Pools emphasizes opulence and ritual.

- Pleasure Gardens turns the ship's luxury into a dangerous hunting ground.
- The Gauntlet presents a controlled spectacle built around competition and timing.
- The Throne Room turns the final fight into a direct confrontation with Calus.
- The Underbelly exposes the hidden machinery beneath that polished exterior.

14. Consolidated Physical Walkthrough

From Start to Finish

- 1. Enter the Leviathan through the Embarkment.
- 2. Follow the exterior approach into the palace and Castellum.
- 3. Complete the active Castellum Standard objective.
- 4. Enter the encounter represented by the active symbol.
- 5. Complete Royal Pools, Pleasure Gardens, or Gauntlet depending on the raid rotation.
- 6. Return to Castellum and complete the next Standard sequence.
- 7. Continue through the remaining rotating encounter doors.
- 8. After the third major encounter, use the Chalice route to reach Calus.
- 9. Enter the Throne Room and begin the Calus encounter.
- 10. Coordinate the projection realm symbol calls with the players in the Throne Room.
- 11. Build Force of Will through the Psionic Skull sequence.
- 12. Damage Calus during the physical-room damage phase.
- 13. Repeat the cycle until Calus is defeated.
- 14. Use the Underbelly separately when hunting secret chests, keys, exploration routes, or shortcuts.

15. Quick Reference — Encounter Mechanics

Encounter	Main mechanic	Primary objective
Castellum	Standards + defense	Deposit and defend 3 Standards
Royal Pools	Plates + chains + Censers	Progress chains, then destroy Censers
Pleasure Gardens	Flowers + Pollen + stealth	Build Empowering Spores, then kill beasts
Gauntlet	Runner + row callouts + charges	Complete runs and deposit charges
Calus	Symbols + projection realm + skulls	Build Force of Will and damage Calus

16. Glossary

- **Castellum:** The central hub and Standard encounter.
- **Standard:** The banner-like objective item deposited at Castellum plates.
- **Standard Liberator:** Enemy that attempts to steal a deposited Standard.
- **Councilor:** Psionic enemy that creates a protective bubble.
- **Psionic Protection:** Buff associated with surviving the Royal Pools' environmental damage.

- **Ceremonial Bather:** Heavy enemy in Royal Pools.
- **Royal Beast:** One of the six hunting animals in Pleasure Gardens.
- **Royal Pollen:** Item carried by ground players in Pleasure Gardens.
- **Empowering Spores:** Damage buff generated by activating flowers near Pollen carriers.
- **Prism Weapon:** Elevated weapon used to activate flowers and support the Pleasure Gardens team.
- **Psionic Charge:** Orb used by runners in the Gauntlet.
- **Mind's Eye:** The projection realm used during the Calus encounter.
- **Force of Will:** Damage-enhancing buff used during Leviathan damage phases.
- **Underbelly:** Hidden maintenance network beneath the main raid spaces.
- **Watcher:** Security drone found in the Underbelly.

17. Historical Note

This document describes the original Destiny 2 Leviathan raid as it existed before vaulting. Names, mechanics, rewards, and encounter behavior are presented as historical raid information. It is not a guide to a currently playable version of Leviathan in the live game.

Prepared as a consolidated reference guide.